Since launch, it has received tremendous community response with more than 1,700 beta downloads, over 700 members of the project's communication tool (over 220 daily active users) and more than 50 committers.

Mainframes are the foundation of businesses in every industry, according to John Mertic, director of program management for The Linux Foundation and the Open Mainframe Project.

"Zowe breathes new life into mainframes and offers innovative possibilities for next generation applications. With Zowe 1.0, we're developing secure, reliable and scalable computing that will ensure the sustainability of mainframes for many years to come," Mertic said.

The Zowe framework will enable an ecosystem of software solutions that is intended to provide a simple, intuitive environment for a variety of IT professionals performing administrative, development, test and operation tasks on z/OS, and help onboard the next generation of mainframe users, the organisation said.

OSI reaffirms commitment to Open Source Definition

The Open Source Initiative (OSI) and affiliate members have pledged to guard and maintain the Open Source Definition (OSD), and recognise the organisation as the steward of this definition.

Founded in late February 1998, OSI is a non-profit organisation dedicated to promoting open source software.

The term 'open source software' was coined in 1998 to describe software that provides a set of precise freedoms and benefits, including but not limited to the freedoms to run, study, redistribute and improve the software on which you rely.

These benefits are codified in the Open Source Definition (OSD), which is based on the Debian Free Software Guidelines. The Open Source Initiative, its members, affiliates, and sponsors, promote and protect this fundamental definition through software licence reviews and approval.

"Without this single, standard definition of 'open source', software development as we know it would not be possible. There is no trust in a world where anyone can invent their own definition for open source, and without trust there is no community, no collaboration, and no innovation," OSI said in a release.

According to the organisation, efforts have been made to undermine the integrity of open source by claiming there is no need for a single, authoritative definition.

These efforts, the OSI said, are motivated by the interests of a few rather than the benefit of all, and are at odds with the principles that have so demonstratively served the open source community well in the past decades.

"If allowed to continue, these efforts will erode the trust of both users and contributors, and hinder the innovation that is enabled by open source software, just as surely as having multiple definitions of a kilogram would erode and undermine commerce," the organisation noted.

Affirming its commitment to the Open Source Definition, the board of directors of the Open Source Initiative concluded, "We acknowledge its importance to the development of the software on which we rely to operate our

Blockstream open sources development of its 'proof of reserves' tool for feedback

Blockchain tech company Blockstream has developed a 'proof of reserves' tool to standardise the authenticity of exchanges' crypto reserves.

The company has submitted a Bitcoin Improvement Proposal (BIP) to the bitcoin-dev mailing list for consideration, and is open sourcing the development of the tool for feedback from the industry.

In the wake of many high-profile hacks over the years, Bitcoin exchanges are increasingly coming under pressure from users and regulators to prove they are managing their users' funds correctly, the company pointed out in a blog post.

"At Blockstream, we've been working on a solution to provide a best-practice standard 'proof of reserves' for the industry, that offers broad compatibility with the way most Bitcoin exchanges are storing their users' funds," the blog post stated.

The blog also noted that lack of standardised methodology for Bitcoin proof of reserves leads to two major problems: poor accessibility and security risks.

Blockstream stated that its original idea was to build a solution for Liquid functionaries to prove their Liquid Bitcoin (L-BTC) reserves to third-party auditors. But it soon recognised

that existing approaches by exchanges for regular Bitcoin reserves had room for improvement, and that its software had wider applications outside of the Liquid network.